

For If We Would Judge Ourselves

Open to 1 Corinthians 11. You may also want to mark Isaiah 53 and Deuteronomy 25.

First Corinthians 11:30 says:

For this cause many are weak and sickly among you, and many sleep.

The word "sleep" means they went home to be with God before it was time. In context, that was regretful to God. Paul says, "For this cause," which means the cause has already been explained in the preceding verses.

This is one of the most asked questions in Pentecostal circles: Why do some people die of disease, even good people, while others are healed? Paul does not leave the question without an answer.

He continues:

For if we would judge ourselves, we should not be judged.

But when we are judged, we are chastened of the Lord, that we should not be condemned with the world.

The world has no resistance against disease outside the blood. But we have a covenant. We do not have to be condemned with the world.

Back up to verse 17:

Now in this that I declare unto you I praise you not, that ye come together not for the better, but for the worse.

They were coming together for communion, but Paul says it was not for the better. Why?

For first of all, when ye come together in the church, I hear that there be divisions among you...

The cause Paul names is division. There were factions, leaders of factions, and doctrines that went with those divisions. People rose up to be approved, recognized, and exalted.

When they came together in that condition, Paul said:

When ye come together therefore into one place, this is not to eat the Lord's supper.

They had a form of godliness and a meal, but it was not the Lord's Supper Jesus instituted.

There are three categories of judgment that can explain why people do not receive healing.

The first is strife or division against God. This is when a person knows what the Word says, knows he is called to go on, but refuses to find or obey the perfect will of God. This can be a preacher or a sheep. If he reaches the fork in the road and chooses his own way, he leaves healing back at the fork. God does not take it from him; he leaves it where he refused the path.

To be healed, he must receive correction, enter relationship with Jesus, go back to where he left his healing, pick it up, and get on the right road.

The second is strife against one another. This is the one Paul is dealing with at the communion table. People think they can attack someone made in the image of God and keep going. Even if someone attacks you, you cannot enter strife and be right. The instigator is wrong, but so is the one who receives the offense and continues in it.

The third is deception or ignorance. A little believer on milk may be under wrong teaching and not know healing belongs to him. Those are often the ones healed most easily in crusades and prayer lines, because they have not yet reached the fork where they knowingly refuse revelation.

Paul says:

For I have received of the Lord that which also I delivered unto you...

Take, eat: this is my body, which is broken for you...

This cup is the new testament in my blood...

The blood united lost humanity back to God. The broken body takes the matter to another level: it unites us back into fellowship with one another.

Substitution and identification teach us that Jesus became what we were so we could become what He is. He was made sin so we could become the righteousness of God in Him. He bore our sickness and carried our pains so we could identify with health. Though He was rich, He became poor so that through His poverty we might be rich.

So what did He mean, "This is My body which was broken for you"?

His natural body was broken in substitution so His spiritual body could be united. His body was torn apart to free the body of Christ from being broken by disease and strife.

That is why we use a loaf. When you come to communion and tear a piece from the loaf, it represents division, separation, disease, and strife. But it also represents substitution: His body was broken so power would be supplied to unite you with your brother, free from strife and disease.

When disease is in your body, the body is not functioning in harmony with itself. When a member turns on other members in the body of Christ, the body cannot function in harmony either.

This is My body, broken for you. Take advantage of the stripes. They are power not only to deliver you from sickness and pain, but from unforgiveness and roots of bitterness.

Paul says:

Whosoever shall eat this bread, and drink this cup of the Lord, unworthily, shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord.

But let a man examine himself...

For he that eateth and drinketh unworthily, eateth and drinketh damnation to himself, not discerning the Lord's body.

We have often thought not discerning the Lord's body only meant failing to understand that healing is in communion. Healing is there. But in this context, rightly discerning the Lord's body means understanding that His body was broken in substitution to free us from the strife that causes disease and division.

If a person understands this and still refuses to judge himself, he eats and drinks judgment.

It is like a driver's license. You study the laws, receive the license, and become responsible for what you know. If you drive seventy-five where you should not, you did not rightly discern the license, and judgment follows. Likewise, when communion reveals what Jesus purchased and you refuse to walk accordingly, you open yourself to judgment.

Isaiah 53 says:

Surely he hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows...

But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities:

The chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.

The chastisement of our lack of peace was upon Him. With His stripes we are healed.

To understand this, go to Deuteronomy 25. Under the law, if there was a controversy between men, the judges judged between them. They justified the righteous and condemned the wicked. If the wicked man was worthy to be beaten, he was caused to lie down and be beaten according to his fault, up to forty stripes.

Jesus stood in our controversy. He took the judgment for our lack of peace. He became our substitute and received the maximum penalty, forty save one, so we could say, "With His stripes I am healed."

Transgressions are the breaking of law. Iniquities go deeper into immoralities and inward corruption. He was wounded for our transgressions and bruised for our iniquities. Then the chastisement for our lack of peace was laid upon Him.

Two men in controversy would stand before judges, and the guilty one would be beaten according to judgment. Jesus came into my controversy with you and said, "Son, I am your substitute. Step aside. I will take the lack of peace."

He stood before the only true righteous Judge, God, and took the penalty in our place.

So when we partake of communion, we remember the blood that reunited us with God and the body broken to free us from strife with each other. We have an opportunity to judge ourselves and not be condemned with the world.

The last time I entered judgment, it only went so far before I judged myself. I had two hen-egg-sized swellings come up on my side and an infection in my colon for a year. I wore suspenders because I could not tighten a belt without pain.

I threw everything at it except being responsible for knowing what God's plan said and taking the next steps necessary to fall in love with Jesus enough to do it. I stood behind His perfect will and admired it, but that was not enough. I had left healing back where He asked me to obey.

One day, stepping down, He came on me and said, "Will you obey Me now?"

I said, "Yes, sir."

I took His correction and announced it to the staff. It was the biggest step in twenty years. The life went out of that thing immediately. The soreness left. The next day it was gone. The infection cleared, and even trouble in my back disappeared.

I thank God for doctors. They can keep you alive in the acceptable will of God. But you can stay alive in the perfect will.

Brother Dene Crane ministered by radio to multitudes in India, with crusades where hundreds of thousands were healed and saved. He met with Jesus frequently.

The first time he was given an audience with God, the sickness of India had overwhelmed him so much that he stopped preaching and sought God. He cried, "Where is the Jesus of the apostle Paul? Where is the One who does these things in the New Testament?"

When he was taken before God, the first question was, "What do you want?"

He started to say he wanted the gifts of the Spirit, workings of miracles, and gifts of healings so he could help the people. But the Holy Ghost intercepted him and said, "No. Do not ask for the gifts. Tell Him you want Jesus."

If you want to find the perfect will of God for your life again, take time to meet with Jesus. Spend a couple of hours falling in love with Him again. Enter His presence with protocol: He is your King. Worship Him, love Him, and honor Him because He redeemed you.

Then pray in tongues. Pray the plan of God. Tell Him you surrender your whole life and that it is not your own anymore.

This is not a formula. It is a relationship.

Find Him again. Tell the Holy Spirit you want Him to teach you how to offer your soul to Jesus in worship and how to get past the brazen altar into His holy place.